

Cement carbon footprint

For every ton of cement manufactured, a ton of CO₂ is emitted. Check out the exclusive Deloitte video on the Playware DVD for details

Chennai goes green

The Chennai government is revamping official accommodation facilities, with a 175 Crore project that will replace tiled houses with apartments

Your green griha



Suzlon One Earth Photo courtesy: Suzlon

It's green everywhere. Going green is now the norm of the day. The revolution is now painting the concrete jungle green. A short trip of our own with the green community.

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In Sanskrit, *Griha* means abode. Sounds more towards the spiritual side of what we normally call home. But that's the extent to which the early generations used to stress on harmony within the home – they considered it close to worship. Experts agree that transforming an existing structure into a green structure could be a daunting task. However, by minor modifications such as appropriate windows at the recommended locations, you could obviate the need for lights during the day. That's primarily the basics of a green home. Your home should be bright during the day without the need to switch on your lights.

According to Mumbai-based architect Sabu Francis, "Indians have traditionally been one of the most 'green' design aware people in the entire world. Our houses from the past speak volumes regarding

the sensitivity displayed. Sadly, much of it is lost in modern urban architecture". We need to catch up from where we've been as Indians. Indians invented the numeral zero and have had a say in the most important discoveries and inventions in the past, but with urbanisation, we seem to have lost drive and creativity and most importantly our concern for our planet – our natural habitat.

With a marginal incremental cost of about 8 per cent, going green is not



Avani Residence is a 5,000 sq. ft residential structure in Hyderabad that complies to LEED Platinum levels



design that is already bad can be difficult to modify"

Sabu Francis

"Just like you cannot really add value to a person who has grown up badly; a

costly at all. According to S Srinivas, Senior Counsellor, CII-Sohrabji Godrej Green Business Centre, "you would recover the incremental cost in about 3-5 years". In fact, if you plan your construction in the planning stages itself, you can expect to recover the costs in a couple of years. According to Apoorv Vij, Research Associate, Energy Environment Technology Development (TERI), you don't have to lose hope if your home was not designed to be a green home. "An existing design can be modified in various ways to make it green. The old water fixtures in washrooms can be replaced with new low-flow fixtures to reduce the amount of water consumed in the building. Use of Bureau of Energy efficiency (BEE) 4/5 star rated appliances can help reduce energy consumption. The bulbs and conventional tubelights in buildings can